

Question:

A 59-year-old woman comes to the physician because of left leg swelling that started after a transcontinental flight. A duplex ultrasound of the left leg shows a noncompressible popliteal vein. A drug is prescribed that inhibits the coagulation cascade. Two weeks later, laboratory studies show: Platelet count 210,000/mm³ Partial thromboplastin time 53 seconds Prothrombin time 20 seconds Thrombin time 15 seconds (control: 15 seconds) Which of the following drugs was most likely prescribed? Answer Choices: A. Alteplase B. Unfractionated heparin C. Apixaban D. Low molecular weight heparin

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> To approach this reasoning problem, we need to analyze the context of the question, which is centered around identifying a drug used to inhibit the coagulation cascade, a critical aspect of treating deep vein thrombosis or pulmonary embolism. From the given options, the most relevant answer is "unfractionated heparin," as it is a widely recognized anticoagulant that affects the coagulation cascade by inhibiting multiple coagulation factors. This aligns with the symptoms and treatment context provided in the scenario. </think> <answer> Unfractionated heparin </answer>

